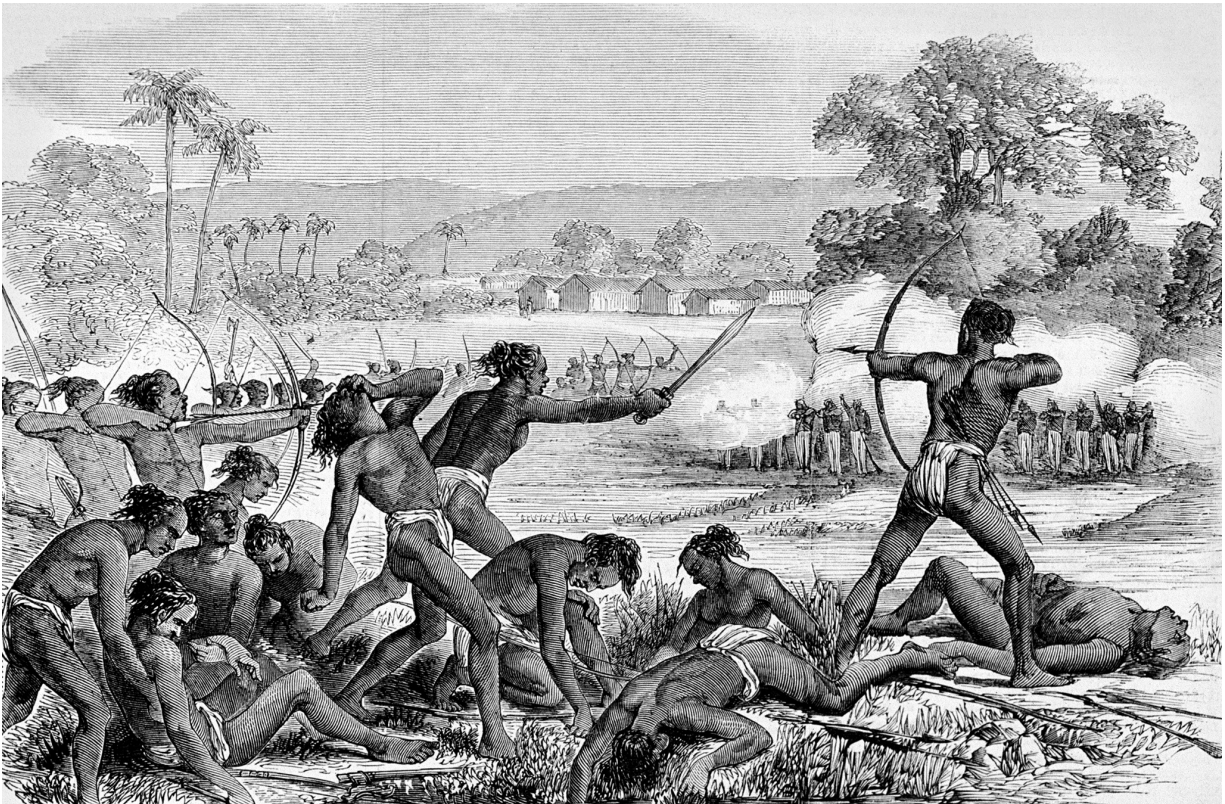


uprisings and rebellions were not new, the earlier ones had remained contained. The Revolt of 1857, however, left an impact on the British as it resulted in a change in how the colony was governed, with India coming under direct British rule in 1858. Before this, however, came the massive Santhal Rebellion, known for its strong connection to the railways.



▲ An artwork depicting an attack by the Santhals on the soldiers of the 40th Regiment Native Infantry.

“The ghosts of 1857 haunted the British ... the colonial residents viewed the railways as their only reliable escape route in the event of another major uprising.”

DAVID CAMPION, “RAILWAY POLICING AND SECURITY IN COLONIAL INDIA, C.1860–1930”

The rise of the Santhals

In 1855–56, the Santhals in the east took up arms because of increasing oppression by local landlords, European indigo planters, and railway builders. With charges of builders bullying labourers and